

# EXPLORE.....

**The newsletter of the  
Friends of Telford Town Park  
FREE - but donations welcome!**



**Summer 2015**

**Promoting . Conserving . Protecting**  
**[www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org](http://www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org)**

# Get active with FOTTP



SUZIE

## WELCOME

to two new members  
of the Friends team



RICHARD

We extend a warm welcome to two new members of the Friends team, Suzie Hurdley as Secretary and Richard Mills as our Treasurer. Suzie was born in Telford and is a trained podiatrist. She enjoys walking and exercising her two energetic dogs. Richard has an excellent background as an accountant most notably with the Ironbridge Gorge Museum Trust. We are now just looking for a **Public Relations manager** to complete the team.

### NOTE

We are very grateful to Great Dawley Town Council for assisting the Friends with the partial cost of producing this newsletter and also to Hollinswood & Randlay Parish Council, Stirchley and Brookside Parish Council, Madeley Town Council, Lawley & Overdale Parish Council and the Southwater Event Group for their ongoing support of the Friends of Telford Town Park. Thank you all very much.

*Cover picture: A view of the new Southwater One  
from high up in the Park play area.*

# 9th Santa Fun Run 2015



**ON YER BIKE, IT'S TELFORD'S 9TH SANTA FUN RUN  
SUNDAY 6 DECEMBER AT 11.30AM  
SUPPORTED BY**



**www.cycleexperience.com    0845 434 8451**

We are very pleased to announce that this year's Santa Fun Run in aid of the RNIB and Guide Dogs UK has been generously supported by CYCLE EXPERIENCE who are situated at the rear of the Visitor Centre. This means we will be able to give even more cash to our two chosen charities of the RNIB and Guide Dogs UK. Last year we raised over £2,500 before costs, so we aim to do a lot more this year. So over to you, get those registration forms filled out and sent off as soon as you can.

Registration is best done online via Paypal but you can also pick up a form from the Visitor Centre. Pre-registration is only **£5** which includes a Santa Suit to run in. If you leave it until the day it will be a £20 registration fee, which is the amount we ask entrants to raise.

[www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org](http://www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org)

01952 - 382340

# Hedge Laying with HSBC



*As part of our ongoing commitment to conserving Telford Town Park, the Friends have recently engaged with HSBC to provide some much needed labour. In this case it was to do some urgently needed hedge laying near Grange Farm Pool entrance.*

*The weather was kind, being both warm and sunny for March and a very pleasant day was had by all. HSBC sent along 4 members of staff who, after some initial instruction from John Trubshaw, really got stuck in. The amount of hedge laying done for first timers was really good and all felt very satisfied at the end of the day to have achieved something they had never done before and very well to boot !*

*There is no doubt, that being in the open air and enjoying some conservation work is very good for both ones physical and mental health. The work is not difficult and when you see the finished result one gets very proud of what has been achieved. Hedge laying is so important for wildlife and the general appearance of the countryside. It gives instant shelter for those birds in particular that like to nest near the ground and offers much in the way of food as well. Great work by FOTTP & HSBC. who have also stated that they want to come back and do more later in the year. To help out, just call 01952 - 382340 and leave your details.*

# Scrub clearing



*Busy clearing unwanted saplings*



*All smiles after a good days work !*



One of several days scrub clearing with Interserve Healthcare personnel. This is another local company that the Friends of Telford Town Park have teamed up with. The first day was a fabulous success with our own John Trubshaw leading the event. This company has committed 3 days of help in the park.

For those that are not familiar with scrub clearing, it is a process of taking out unwanted saplings and other potentially bad growth on the park's heathlands. If this was not done from time to time, the open areas of heath in the park would very soon become dense forest again destroying the natural wildlife. Such species as the dingy skipper butterfly would not be able to breed or feed for example. This is very labour intensive work which is why the Friends become involved in this particular form of conservation.

If you would like to have a crack at it, just give us a call. It is without doubt a very healthy thing to do, both for physical and mental health. Sessions last from around 9.30am until 3.30pm.

Contact: 01952 - 382340 and leave your details.

# Chelsea Gardens



*The Friends Sensory Garden has wintered well and continues to offer visitors a unique experience of touching, feeling and smelling not only plants but water and sculpture as well. If you have not visited yet, do so soon, you will be well rewarded!*

*On the right is a picture of one of the ponds in the Chelsea Gardens. It is looking good but we will be glad when the fountains are all back in action as it adds much to these gardens and brings them alive! To the left of the bronze horse statue is a sculpture where the Telford time capsule is now buried.*



*The Friends operate regular gardening sessions in the Chelsea Gardens. If you would like to help out, just come along one Wednesday between 10am and 1pm and have a chat. No gardening experience is necessary and we have jobs to suit all tastes and abilities. The satisfaction of seeing your handiwork grow and bloom is a fantastic reward as well lowering blood pressure and improving mental wellbeing.*

*If you feel you could benefit from helping out, either pop in or leave your details on 01952 - 382340 and we will be in touch.*

**[www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org](http://www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org)**

# Junior FOTTP

**FUN  
FOR  
KIDS**



## Junior Rangers

Would you like your children to become involved with learning about maintaining the environment of Telford Town Park's 450 acres (170 hectares) and what it does for the health and wellbeing of ALL Telford residents?

The Friends of Telford Town Park would like to start up a **Junior Rangers** section of the Friends aimed at **10 -16 year olds**. This would become an established group under the Friends umbrella, with a responsible DBS checked manager.

Initially it would be designed around a programme of activities probably on a Saturday morning for a couple of hours, learning about what makes **Telford Town Park** tick and becoming actively involved in the general maintenance of the local nature reserve. No membership fees are proposed but once you have signed up, reasonably regular attendance would be expected.

If you are interested in this project, please send your details to: [REDACTED] or you may leave your contact details with the Town Park reception on : **01952 – 382340**. There will be no commitment from you at this stage.

***We look forward to hearing from you.***

# News Round Up



*The Friends have been very active lately promoting the Town Park and the Friends group, 2 days in ASDA Telford and 2 days in Telford Shopping Mall.*



*Recently the Green Flag Award judges paid a visit to Telford Town Park and The Friends to assess our park to see if it could be awarded Green Flag status.*

*The two judges seemed very impressed with what they saw and heard, particularly with the Friends group, so it is fingers crossed now until we hear the result of their findings around August/September time.*



*If you are out and about in the Park this year you may well come across our new A board describing what work is being carried out by the volunteers.*

*It also carries our logo and a message to come and join us to help Promote, Conserve and Protect our lovely park.*

# News Round Up



*Great news, there are now some more steps into the QE 2 Arena. No more slithering down the steep grassy bank! These steps go from near the Aerial Rope Course down into the Arena. Wheelchair access is still available at the far end of the Arena.*

*Right. The beautiful new sculpture which can be found between the rear doors of Telford Library and the Bandstand in the Park.*

*It has an inscription on it written by a 12 year old Telford schoolboy, "Telford is a Prize to the Eyes".*

*Take a trip to the library, have a play on the new digital table with photos of old Telford, then pop out of the rear doors and wander into the Park.*



*Right. One of several new way markers placed in the Park by way of the Heritage Lottery fund. This one is situated near the rear of the Visitor Centre surrounded by a sea of yellow flowers. You will find these markers all over the Park and are a considerable help in finding your way around our 450 acre park. You will also find smaller markers for the Heritage and Ecology trails. Maps are also available from the Visitor Centre.*



Please support our Santa Fun Run sponsors, Telford Cycle Centre.

They have bikes for hire, cycle repairs and sales along with cycle training for ALL ages. They are situated at the rear of the Visitor Centre and open from 10 -4.30 Tuesdays - Sundays inclusive.

**0845 - 4348451**

**[www.cycleexperience.com](http://www.cycleexperience.com)**



Telford Town Park's aerial rope course and climbing wall. Phone **0845 - 8802477** or book online at: [www.closetotheedge.co.uk](http://www.closetotheedge.co.uk)

Town Park  
Adventure Golf  
Course  
Loads of fun for all  
ages

Tickets from the  
Visitor Centre

**01952 -382340**



*Courtesy of the Shropshire Star*

# ***Telford Town Park***



*Clockwise from top left: Spring in the Chelsea Gardens, the big chute in the play area, the Remembrance Memorial, Autumn colours, the Crannog bridge and pathway, a Tree Creeper. For info on these places pick up a trail leaflet at the Visitor Centre.*

# WHAT'S ON IN THE PARK

**There's always lots going on in the Park for people of all ages. With the Summer Holidays coming up there's plenty for children and families and a lot of it is free of charge.**

Every Saturday  
Childrens Mountain Bike Ride  
Visitor Centre  
Bicycle Try Out - Roadshow  
RSPB Wildlife Encounters  
Visitor Centre

Group Guide Bike Rides  
Visitor Centre

Butterfly Workshop  
Booking essential  
Archaeological Dig  
Booking required  
Heritage Walk

Muddy Madeness with  
Shropshire Wildlife Trust  
Woodland Homes with  
Shropshire Wildlife Trust  
Learn to Balance & Ride

Wednesday 11 November  
Sunday 6 December

Entry online £5. On the day £20. Register at [www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org](http://www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org)

Park Run 08.30am - 10.30am.

Wed 22 July, 29 July, 5 Aug, 12 Aug, 19 Aug,  
26 Aug, 2 Sept. 10am - 12noon £5 per session.

Sat 25 July, Sat 26 Sept 10am - 4pm FREE

Sun 26 July, Sat 8 Aug, Wed 12 Aug,  
Thur 13 Aug, Wed 27 Aug, Thur 28 Aug,  
All 10am FREE

Sun 26 July, Sun 2 Aug, Sun 9 Aug,  
Sun 16 Aug, Sun 23 Aug, Sun 30 Aug,  
Sun 6 Sept, Sun 13 Sept. All 1pm FREE  
Thur 30 July 10am & 1pm. Sessions last 2hours.  
01952 - 382340

Tue 28 July to Fri 31 July inclusive.  
10am - 4pm every day.

Fri 31 July, Thur 3 Sept 11.0am FREE  
Booking required  
Sun 9 Aug 11.0am FREE

Sun 13 Sept, 11.0am FREE

Every Sat 11.0am £3 per session.

Remembrance Day 11.0am  
Santa Fun Run 11.30am



## **24 July - 2 August is Love Parks Week**

Visit the Town Park website for details of what's on in the Park  
in support of this national week to celebrate our green spaces.



## **Keep up to date with the Friends of Telford Town Park**

Visit our website [www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org](http://www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org)

Find us on Facebook <https://www.facebook.com/FOTTP>

Follow us on Twitter <https://twitter.com/FOTTP>

Call into the Park Visitor Centre or telephone 01952 - 382340

